

Why You Shouldn't Just Prompt in ChatGPT (And What to Use Instead)

When you're working with **Alpha Prompts**—your structured templates for visual direction—how you manage your tools really matters.

ChatGPT often shortens long inputs or loses critical details in very descriptive prompts. This becomes a problem when you're trying to combine:

- A detailed Alpha Prompt
- A specific style description or emotional narrative
- Reference-based refinements

This is why **Claude (CLOD)** is a more effective tool for Alpha Prompt editing. Claude handles longer inputs and keeps them intact.

Your process can look like this:

1. Take an Alpha Prompt template.
2. Expand and customize it in Claude, using either a reference image or a very detailed description of your desired outcome.
3. Once it's fully written and refined, copy that complete Alpha Prompt over to ChatGPT.

Here's the key part: In ChatGPT, open a **new chat for each Alpha Prompt**. This means you'll have one dedicated chat thread per visual style or creative direction, not one per individual image. Within that single thread, you can generate multiple variations that all share the same visual signature.

To stay organized, consider creating a folder—for example, "AI-Image"—where each chat is tied to a specific look. This might include distinct styles like "desert editorial," "studio still life," or "urban night motion." This practice helps prevent **cross-contamination** from earlier prompts and stops ChatGPT from inadvertently dragging old details into new images.

Reference Images: Use With Intention, Not as a Crutch

Uploading reference photos can be tempting, but it often leads to simple copying rather than true creation. A good rule of thumb is to **look at the reference, then describe it in your own words**.

Ask yourself:

- What do you like about the reference?
- What should be different in your version?
- What story should your version tell?

Instead of just uploading an image and saying "like this," provide specific instructions. For instance, you could say:

"Use the same harsh side lighting as in the reference, but change the subject's pose and outfit. Keep the background dark concrete instead of beige."

This approach ensures you remain inspired, rather than dependent, and helps you maintain **ethical clarity** in your creative process.

Key Insights:

- **Write Alpha Prompts in Claude.**
- **Create one ChatGPT thread per Alpha Prompt style.**
- **Iterate from there**—stay organized and sharp.
- **Use references as guides, not as strict templates.**
- **Build your own archive of styles with clean, separated chats.**